



SKOAR! @ THE INDIAN ESPORTS CHAMPIONSHIP!

The first ever leSC proved to be a great platform for the nation's gamers

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The Indian eSports Championship, or leSC for short, was an initiative taken by Essence Transmedia and Neon Gaming Studios with the intention of promoting the fast growing gaming community in India. The leSC tournaments took place over a period of 48 days at a national level, with gamers taking part from across the nation. Players were playing both via LAN from gaming cafes and online from their homes. This gave both professional and amateur gamers from around to country a platform to showcase their gaming skills. The total prize pool of the Indian eSports Championship was a whopping 20 lakhs.

leSC started off with the Cafe Warz, which was held in Mumbai for the gaming cafe owners of the city. There were many teams fighting to represent their cafe. This was followed by a knockout tournament online and over 140 teams participated in this tourney.

Following the Cafe Warz there were online tournaments for the remainder of the month with well over 200 teams participating in them from across the country. The main event, Ground Zero,

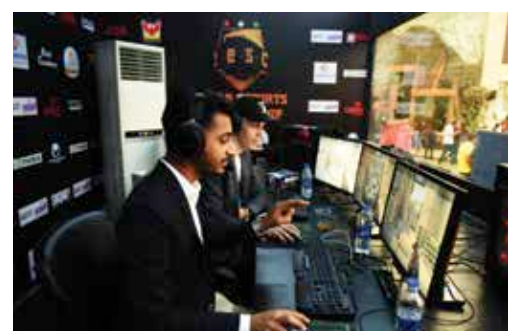
took place in Phoenix Market City from 10th to 12th November. We got there just in time to witness the last two matches of day 2, both of which had Brutality playing in them and they were a sight to behold. The main event had a total of 8 teams shortlisted from across the country to compete against each other in matches of CS:GO and Dota 2. Brutality went on to win the CS:GO championship and Roar Esports took the prize for Dota 2. Both Brutality and Roar Esports walked away with a cash prize of 3 lakhs each.

There was a separate tourney for the FIFA gamers as well, the winners of which were also awarded with cash prizes. leSC also had a cosplay competition.

leSC had a special casting booth prepared for the casters; a nice cozy space to cast games in comfort. Caster 'Stamination' representing Drag2Death came in from abroad specially for the event. The casting for the event was especially enjoyable.

In addition to all of the above, there were booths around the venue as well with people playing CS:GO, Counter Strike Source and Dota 2. There was an HTC Vive set up for people wanting to try out the VR experience and a lot of other fun little activities.

Here's what Mr. Ashish Jain, Chief Development Officer of Essence Transmedia had to say about the leSC, "Indian eSports Championship 2016



received an exceptional response from the industry stakeholders. Our aim was to provide a healthy eco-system to the gaming industry and we will continue to support them with bigger and better competitive events in the future. With the growing awareness and immense global popularity, we are hopeful that eSports will soon be included to the Olympic 2024 program. The inclusion of eSports in Olympic 2024 will be a solid stepping stone and will give a big boost to the esports scene in India."

The event ended with performances from the cast of the Bollywood movie Wajah Tum Ho. leSC received a positive response from the community and we're definitely hoping they'll be back next year for round 2! *